HHH–B–691c
August 10, 1961

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. HHH–B–00691b (AGR–AMS)
August 12, 1960 and
Fed. Spec. HHH–B–691a
October 28, 1941

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BROCCOLI, FRESH, BUNCHED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Size. Minimum stalk diameter larger than required in the Fancy grade and sizes (both minimum diameter and minimum and maximum length) desired for other grades may be specified in terms of inches and quarter inches.

1.2 Grades. Bunched broccoli shall be of the following grades, as specified (see 6.1).

Fancy (see 3.2.1).

No. 1 (see 3.2.2).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standard:

MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following publications form a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

(Copies of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order,

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coupon, or cash to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

United States Standards for Bunched Italian Sprouting Broccoli.

(Single copies of the United States Standards for Bunched Italian Sprouting Broccoli may be obtained without charge from the U. S. Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C.)

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, P. O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington 4, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall comply in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.2 Description of grades. Unless otherwise specified, the interpretation of requirements (descriptive terms) contained in 3.2.1 and 3.2.2 shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Bunched Italian Sprouting Broccoli in effect on date of invitation for bids.

3.2.1 *Fancy.* "Fancy" consists of bunched stalks of Italian Sprouting Broccoli. Each bunch shall be free from decay, and from damage. The bud clusters in each bunch shall be generally compact. Each bunch shall be neatly and fairly evenly cut off at the base, and closely trimmed unless otherwise specified as "well trimmed". The minimum diameter of each stalk shall be not less than 2½ inches. A larger minimum diameter may be specified. The length of each stalk shall be not less than 6 inches nor more than 8½ inches. *Tolerances:* Not more than 10 percent of the bunches in any container may be below the requirements of the grade, but not more than one-fifth of this amount, or 2 percent, shall be allowed for bunches affected by decay. Percentages shall be determined on the basis of count, except that when bunches are not fairly uniform in size, percentages shall be determined on the basis of weight. In addition, not more than 10 percent, by weight, of the stalks in any container may fail to meet the size requirements of the grade or any sizes specified for length and diameter. When a percentage of the broccoli in a lot is specified to be "heads" or of a certain diameter and larger, no part of any tolerance shall be used to reduce such a percentage for the lot as a whole; but individual containers may contain not over 15 percent less than the percentage specified, provided that the entire lot averages within the percentage specified.

3.2.2 *No. 1.* "No. 1" consists of bunched stalks of Italian Sprouting Broccoli. Each bunch shall be free from decay, and from damage. The bud clusters in each bunch shall be generally fairly compact. Each bunch shall be neatly and fairly evenly cut off at the base, and well trimmed, unless otherwise specified as "closely trimmed", "fairly well trimmed", or "leafy". There are no requirements for diameter, but diameter, may be specified in any lot. Unless otherwise specified, the length of each stalk shall be not less than 5 inches nor more than 9 inches. *Tolerances:* Same as Fancy (see 3.2.1).

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling. Samples of broccoli offered under this specification may be selected by the Government inspector, examined, and tested at any time to determine if it is in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *General.* Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative, at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the packing house, both during and after packing, at any suitable point in transit and/or after delivery to the point of destination. If inspection is made during the time of packing, the passing as satisfactory of any detail of packing or materials shall not relieve the contractor of respon-

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sibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.1.1 *(For Military agencies only).* The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2.2 *Final inspection.* Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.3 and 6.4).

4.2.3 *USDA certificate of quality and condition.* When specified by the procuring agency the contractor shall furnish a U. S. Department of Agriculture, Federal or Federal-State certificate of quality and condition as outlined in procurement documents.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Chemical analyses.* Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the methods of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists in effect on the date of invitation for bids, or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement, the definitions and applications of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Federal Standard No. 102.

5.1 Packaging, level C. Unless otherwise specified, commercial packaging is acceptable.

5.2 Packing, level C. Unless otherwise specified, broccoli shall be packed in commercial crates, or cartons, which shall be clean, sound, well filled, securely covered, and so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common carriers for safe transportation to the point of destination specified in shipping instructions at lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Each container shall be packed so that the broccoli in the shown face shall be reasonably representative in size, color and quality of the contents of the containers. Incident to proper packing, as herein defined, not more than 5 percent of the units may fail to meet the foregoing requirements: Provided, that no individual requirement shall be deliberately disregarded.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.*

5.3.1.1 *Labeling.* Any commercial labeling or additional labeling, as specified, that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder, is acceptable.

5.3.1.2 *Marking for shipment.* Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of Federal Standard No. 123 and such other information as specified by individual agencies.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.*

5.3.2.1 *Labeling.* Labeling in accordance with 5.3.1.1 will be acceptable.

5.3.2.2 *Marking of shipping containers.* Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129 when so prescribed by the procuring activity.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) The size of broccoli required, if other than specified in the grade (see 1. . .

(*b*) The grade of broccoli required (see 1.2).

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6.2 If samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.3 Contractor's inspection. The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.4 Destination inspection. When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.5 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Vegetables, fresh, not otherwise indexed by name, other than cold pack.

Carload minimum weight 20,000 pounds.

Motor:

Vegetables, fresh, not otherwise indexed, other than cold pack.

Motor volume minimum weight 20,000 pounds.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—Q M

Navy—S MC

Air Force—MAAMA

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Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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